

SUMMARY

I am an economist at the United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO). Before taking up my current post, I was a researcher at the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences and a lecturer at the Stockholm School of Economics (the Swedish Program). Experienced in stakeholder engagement, policy analysis, project management, proposal development, and grant applications. Extensive international expertise through research visits, missions, conferences, and workshops. I widely use quantitative methods (experimental and quasi-experimental research design) to provide policy-oriented research outputs.

AREAS OF RESEARCH INTEREST

Primary areas: Economics of environment, agriculture and development

Secondary areas: Social network theory, applied spatial econometrics, and data science

EDUCATION

PhD, Economics , Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden	2014-2019
Visiting PhD student , University of Western Australia, Perth-Australia	June-Aug. 2018
MSc., Economics , Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden	2010-2013
MSc., Rural Development , Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Uppsala-Sweden	2009-2011
BA., Economics , Jimma University, Jimma, Ethiopia	2004-2007

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Economist - United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	Jan. 2022 to present
Policy Analyst - United Nations Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)	Sept. 2021 - Dec. 2021
Researcher - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences	Jan. 2019 - Dec. 2020
Doctoral Researcher - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences Department of Economics, Uppsala, Sweden	Aug. 2014 - Dec. 2018
Research Assistant - Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Department of Economics, Uppsala, Sweden	Dec. 2013 - May 2014
Junior Planner - Ethio Telecom, Transformation Program Office, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	Sept. 2007 - Oct. 2009

SELECTED PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES

- (1) **Tirkaso, W.T.**, and Hailu, A. (2022). Does Neighborhood Matter? The Effect of Spatial Proximity on Farmers Technical Efficiency Level. *Agricultural Economics*, 1-13.
- (2) Marbuah, G., Gren, I-M., and **Tirkaso, W.T.** (2021). Social capital, economic development and carbon emissions: Empirical evidence from counties in Sweden. *Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews*, 152(2021), 111691.
- (3) Gren, I-M., and **Tirkaso, W.T.** (2021). Cost effective reduction in emissions of greenhouse gases – Fuel and food consumption and negative emissions in Sweden. *Energy Economics*, 105638.
- (4) **Tirkaso, W.T.**, and Gren, I-M. (2021). Evaluation of cost efficiency in hydropower related biodiversity restoration projects in Sweden: A stochastic frontier approach. *Journal of Environmental Planning and Management*, 1-20.
- (5) **Tirkaso, W.T.**, and Gren, I-M.(2020). Road Fuel Demand and Regional Effects of Carbon Taxes in Sweden *Energy Policy*, 144(2020), 111648.

- (6) Nsabimana, A., and **Tirkaso, W.T.** (2019). Examining Coffee Export Performance in East African Countries: *Do Bilateral Trade Relations Matter?* Agrekon, 1-19.

WORKING PAPERS AND BOOK CHAPTERS

- (1) **Tirkaso, W.T.** (2023). On the Impact of Rural Electrification: The Role of Complementary Factors. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4377190>
- (2) **Tirkaso, W.T.**, Sandin, Leonard., Segersten, Joel., Spjut, David., and Degerman, Erik.(2018). Selected Studies in Biodiversity. In Şen, Bülent(Ed.), "Biodiversity Restoration and Renewable Energy from Hydropower: Conflict or Synergy?". pp. 120-131. ISBN:978-1-78923-233-2.
- (3) Marbuah, G., **Tirkaso, W.T.**, and Gren, I-M. (2016). Cost-effective Policy and Incomplete Information on Policy Implementation. In H., Liljenström and U, Svedin (Ed.), "Towards a Fossil-Free Society - in the Stockholm-Mälars Region". pp. 134-152. ISBN: 978-91-976048-4-0

TECHNICAL AND PROGRAMING SKILLS

- Production of Technical and Scientific Documentation: Microsoft Office and LaTeX
- Econometrics and Data Analysis Softwares: Stata, R, ArcGIS/QGIS and Python (basic).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences, Department of Economics

Microeconomics (Bachelor level course)

Spring 2016

Environmental Economics (Bachelor level course)

Spring 2016

The Swedish Program - Stockholm School of Economics (SSE)

Energy and Environmental Economics (Bachelor level course)

Fall 2021, Spring 2022

WORKSHOPS, CONFERENCE AND PRESENTATIONS

- (1) The 2019 AAEA Annual Meeting. Agricultural & Applied Economics Association, Atlanta, 21-23 July 2019.
- (2) 26th Ulvön Conference on Environmental Economics. Umeå University and the Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences (SLU), Sweden, 18-20 June 2019.
- (3) EAAE Seminar 168: Behavioural Perspectives in Agricultural Economics and Management. The Swedish University of Agricultural Sciences (SLU), Sweden, 6-7 February 2019.
- (4) 2nd Nordic Annual Environmental and Resource Economics (NAERE) Workshop. Norwegian School of Economics (NHH), Norway, 12-13 April. 2018.
- (5) 15th European Workshop on Efficiency and Productivity Analysis (EWEPA). Loughborough University, UK, 12-15 June. 2017.
- (6) Euroleague for Life Science Scientific(ELLS) Student Conference. University of Hohenheim, Germany, 11-12 November. 2016.
- (7) International Society of Ecological Economics (ISEE) 2016 Conference. University of the District of Columbia, USA, 26-29 June. 2016.
- (8) Euroleague for Life Science Scientific(ELLS) Student Conference. Boku University of Natural Resource and Life Sciences, Austria, 14-16, November. 2013.
- (9) Evaluation of Cost Efficiency in Hydro-Power Related Biodiversity Restoration Projects in Sweden. Centre for Environmental and Resource Economics (CERE), Umea Univeristy, Sweden, 25 October. 2017.